

COLLABORATION

Data Validation

→ used to control what users can enter into a cell.

Ex: dropdown lists

whole numbers only

dates only

Creating a dropdown list

1. Select cell
2. Data Tab → Data Validation
3. Allow → List
4. Source → select list values
5. OK

Now a drop down appears

Data Validation Uses

Dashboard filters

- choose
- Country
 - department
 - Job Title
 - Month

from dropdowns

Protecting Data

→ Used to prevent users from modifying important cells.

- Ex:
- formulas
 - Dashboards
 - Reports

Why use dropdowns?

- Prevent users from typing incorrect values.
- Users can only choose from the list.
- Improves data quality

Data Entry forms

- Allow only valid entries

Prevent Errors

- Ensures consistent data.

Note: Every cell is locked by default.

→ when you open a new Excel workbook

Every cell already has locked property enabled.

You can check by: Right click → format cells → protection

You will see locked

Then why can I edit Every cell

→ Because the worksheet is not protected

→ so Excel ignores those lock

Result: You can edit every cell

what happens after protect sheet

Suppose: all cells are locked

Then you click: Review → protect sheet

Now Excel activates the locks

Result: locked cells → cannot edit

what if I want some cells Editable?

Suppose: I want users to enter

- Job title

- Country

→ but formulas should not be changed.

Step 1: Select input cells Ex: C2 : C4

Step 2: Right click → format cells → protection
uncheck ☐ locked.

Now	cell	locked?
	C2	No
	C5	yes
	C4	No

Step 3: Protect the sheet

Now :	Cell	Editable ?
	C2	Yes
	C3	Yes
	C4	Yes
	Other	NO

→ only unlocked cells can be edited.

Note :-

Before Protect sheet

All cells locked

↓

sheet not protected

↓

Everything editable

After Protect sheet

locked cells

↓

Cannot edit

↓

unlocked cells

↓

can edit

Practical dashboard setup

→ User can change

- Job title
- Country
- Month

} using dropdowns

→ User cannot change

- formulas
- charts
- Calculations